

Run Past Your Potential

"Run past your potential," is the ASICS slogan for 2025. At ASICS, we believe in the potential of all those who are willing to challenge themselves and we encourage them to press on. Likewise, we strive to be an unrelenting force that never stops moving forward. In this edition of our integrated report, our fifth since the inaugural *Integrated Report 2020*, we want to convey ASICS' potential for further growth in the years to come.

Yasuhito Hirota

Chairperson and Chief Executive Officer (CEO), Representative Director

Message from the CEO



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Assessment of 2024, the First Year of Mid-Term Plan 2026

2024 marked the first year of Mid-Term Plan 2026, and we hit the ground running. Since we have already hit all the original 2026 targets announced in November 2023, we updated the plan with new numerical targets in November 2024. For me, the standout achievement of 2024 is reaching the ¥100.0 billion milestone in operating profit for the first time, as it confirms what I have been saying all along: that ASICS has reached an entirely new level.

Following the same path as our Performance Running category, ASICS' net sales base, the SportStyle and Onitsuka Tiger categories are on track to increase net sales to the ¥100.0 billion mark as well. I believe that these businesses can serve as the second and third pillars for ASICS going forward.

2024 marked the first year of operations with our new management structure under the leadership of current president and COO Mr. Tominaga. I feel that it was also a year of major change from global and digital perspectives.

On the global front, we expanded communication more than ever by having the CEOs of each regional operating company report directly to Mr. Tominaga at our global headquarters. In addition, Executive Board Meetings, which were previously limited to Japanese members of the executive body, are now attended by non-Japanese members when topics with a global impact are on the agenda. Discussions on these topics are held in English. Increasingly, department head roles are being taken on by members outside Japan. This all adds up to an organizational structure that is becoming ever more global.

On the digital front, we are making progress with the introduction of globally-unified, mission-critical systems, an effort Mr. Tominaga has been involved with since joining ASICS in his previous role as the senior general manager of the IT Division. As a result, we are gaining a granular, real-time understanding of the state of business in each region, down to each store and product. We have already begun using these systems for demand forecasting and production planning. I believe they will help greatly with making forecasts more accurate and with optimizing inventory, which will ultimately improve our profit margins.

The Founding Philosophy and Establishment of the ASICS Foundation

2024 also marked ASICS' 75th anniversary. Since the beginning, our philosophy has been, "*Anima Sana In Corpore Sano*," which translates to "a sound mind in a sound body."

ASICS was founded after World War II with only two employees and ¥300,000 in capital. While living in Kobe City, Japan after serving in the war, the Company's founder, Kihachiro Onitsuka, witnessed the tragic reality of the youth with his own eyes. Listless, lost, and with nowhere to go, they turned to delinquency to fill the void. As he thought of ways to help solve this problem, he concluded that sports could give young people hope, and so the Company was born. Mr. Onitsuka's original wish lives on as ASICS' founding philosophy to this very day. In that same spirit, we conduct business with the goal of creating a world where any one of us can continue to exercise, play sports, and remain in good mental and physical health throughout our lives.

In July 2024, we announced that we were looking into establishing the ASICS Foundation, a general incorporated foundation. The foundation will provide grants to organizations that use sports and exercise initiatives to support young people, people with disabilities, women, and any others who face social or economic hardships. In addition to Japan, the foundation will primarily target its efforts in regions where ASICS operates production sites, such as Vietnam, Indonesia, India, and Cambodia.

As part of our never-ending commitment to improving corporate value, we have decided to work through the ASICS Foundation to address social issues related to sports and exercise. I believe this will enable us to bring better mental and physical health to more people than ever before.



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As part of the consideration process, we engaged in earnest engagement with shareholders and maintained close communication to ensure that they had a clear understanding of the significance of establishing the foundation as well as its objectives. I believe that we were able to have in-depth discussions on the matter, particularly regarding the method of establishment, ultimately bringing shareholders who were initially lukewarm around to the idea. In the end, several shareholders showed their support for the plan at the General Meeting of Shareholders held in March 2025, and establishment of the foundation was given the go-ahead. My hope is to make this foundation a new means to create value for ASICS, working hand in hand with our stakeholders. We are investigating ways to provide readers and stakeholders with regular updates on ASICS Foundation activities as we move forward.

Facing of the Global Capital Market

This past year also served as a strong reminder that ASICS is a part of the global market. I had many investor relations (IR) meetings overseas, and the interactions I had with investors brought one particular issue to my attention. The question that came up time and time again was “Why does ASICS continue to hold cross-shareholdings?” Since ASICS is a global brand, I believe that our capital and financial standing should meet global standards, and so we have decided to eliminate all cross-shareholdings held by the ASICS Group.

At the same time, we approached financial institutions and other shareholders who held ASICS shares as cross-shareholdings about the prospect of selling, and in July we conducted a secondary offering of shares worth ¥200 billion. Our shareholder structure needs reform. Since there will no longer be so-called stable shareholders, we will need to face capital markets head-on. I made the choice to be prepared as a manager in charge of a company that faces constant pressure from capital markets. Going forward, ASICS will need to manage its business with even greater transparency and urgency, which may open us up to a new level of expectations and criticism from shareholders. However, I believe we can use both these expectations and critical voices, and ultimately the dynamism of the global market as a force to drive us forward and an impetus for future growth.

Another result of our secondary offering of shares was a significant jump in the number of individual shareholders. I would like to engage in active communication with even more individuals, turn them into ASICS fans, and eventually have them become individual investors who purchase shares. In March 2025, we held our first IR meeting for individual investors in Okinawa City. We also held these meetings in Fukuoka City in May and in Hokkaido City in June. I joined the meetings in Okinawa City



and Hokkaido City and spoke directly with individual investors. Our management team plans to keep visiting major cities and prefectures across Japan in the future and bring with us an interactive IR experience. I welcome you to join one of these events.

In Closing

At ASICS, we believe our mission is to contribute to people’s physical and mental health. This philosophy remains the unchanging foundation of all ASICS’ business activities. The environment surrounding ASICS may be undergoing major changes—shifts in the global situation, geopolitical risks, and otherwise—but amid all of it ASICS will keep on running!

As the 2025 slogan says, “Run past your potential.” We will do the same.



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